1. For the memory of Ashoka, see the collection of articles in Olivelle (2009), especially Deeg (2009). Also see Strong (1989) and Ray (2012). For the historical traditions of ancient India, Thapar (2013).

2. While the *Vayu Purana* and the *Brahmanda Purana* mention Kunala, Bandhupalita, Indrapalita, Devavarma, Shatadhanus, and Brhadratha, the *Matsya Purana* list is made up of four names—Dasharatha, Samprati, Shatadhanvan, and Brhadratha. A list of seven is provided in the *Vishnu Purana*—Kulala, Bandhupalita, Dashona, Dasharatha, Samprati, Shalisuka, Devadharman, Shatadhanvan, and Brhadratha. As for Buddhist texts, the *Ashokavadana's* list is made up of several names that do not figure in the *Puranas*. The five kings mentioned are Sampadi, Vrihaspati, Vrishasena, Pushyadharman, and Pushyamitra. The Tibetan scholar Taranatha, on the other hand, mentioned only Vigatashoka and Virasena.

3. Pargiter (1913): 29.

4. For the Satavahanas and their successors, Chattopadhyay (2014): 71–95.

5. Strong (1989): 292.

6. Sastri (1967): 245.

7. While the dynasty is said to have come to an end around 180 BCE, there are occasional references to later rulers related to the Mauryas. Bhandarkar, for instance, draws attention to Xuanzang's allusion to Purnavarman, a king of Magadha who ruled some time before the Chinese traveller's visit. Purnavarman is said to have restored the Bodhi tree destroyed by Sashanka, king of Karnasuvarna (Bengal). He is described by the Chinese pilgrim as the 'last of the race of Asokaraja'. Bhandarkar (1957): 49.

8. Raychaudhuri (1953): 328.

9. Strong (1989): 294.

10. For details of the caves at Nagarjuni hill and Dasharatha's epigraphs, Basham (1951): 151–2,154–6. The Gopika cave is a single rectangular chamber with a vaulted roof; the Vahiyaka cave is similarly shaped; the Vadathika cave is smaller and less imposing than the other two.

11. The Sudama cave and the Vishvamitra cave at Barabar, as also the Vahiyaka and Vadathika caves at Nagarjuni, show such defacement. Basham (1951): 157.

12. Pratishthanapura is modern Paithan in Maharashtra while Pokhara is Pushkar in Rajasthan. Many other place-names figure as well. See Marshall, Foucher, and Majumdar (1940): vol. 1, 297–